

Unlocking Potential: A Guide to Sports for Children With Special Needs (CWSN)

@ThunderStudy

FOUNDATIONAL CONCEPTS



CWSN: Children With Special Needs
This term refers to children who are differently-abled or have disabilities, requiring special attention and programs.



Disability vs. Disorder
A **disability** is a permanent condition restricting body function (e.g., a lost limb), while a **disorder** is often a temporary, brain-related ailment.

A Shift in Language: Around 1980, "differently-abled" was introduced as a respectful alternative to "disabled" or "handicapped" to reduce discrimination.

Adaptive Sports: These are sports programs specifically designed for differently-abled individuals, featuring modified rules and equipment to ensure ease of play.



SPECIAL OLYMPICS
"Let the wiv, but if I cannal win, let me be brave in the attempt."

For Intellectual Disabilities:
A global event exclusively for athletes with intellectual disabilities, focusing on participation and effort.

Founded in 1986 by Eunice Kennedy Shriver.



PARALYMPICS
"Spirit in Motion"

The Premier Event for a Range of Disabilities:
The largest multi-sport event for elite athletes with various physical, sensory, and intellectual disabilities.

Inspired by Sir Ludwig Guttmann, officially started in 1980.



DEAFLYMPICS
"International Silent Games."

Elite Competition for Deaf Athletes:
An international multi-sport event for athletes with a hearing loss of at least 66 decibels.

Founded in 1924.

Feature	Special Olympics	Paralympics	Deaflympics
Primary Athletes	Intellectually Disabled	Wide Range of Disabilities	Deaf / Hard of Hearing
Frequency	Every 2 years (Summer/Winter)	Every 4 years (Summer/Winter)	Every 4 years (Summer/Winter)
Governing Body	SGI (Special Olympics Int'l)	IPC (Int'l Paralympic Committee)	ICSD (Int'l Committee of Sports for the Deaf)
Key Focus	Participation, Joy, Courage	Elite Athletic Performance	Elite Athletic Performance
Indian Body	Special Olympics Bharat	Paralympic Committee of India	All India Sports Council of the Deaf

ENSURING FAIR COMPETITION

Classification vs. Divisioning: These are two distinct methods for grouping athletes to ensure fair and equitable competition.



CLASSIFICATION
(in Paralympics)

Primary Basis: Type and impact of the athlete's disability on their sport.
Goal: Group athletes with similar functional limitations.
Process: Involves medical and functional assessments by officials.



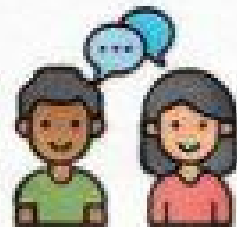
DIVISIONING
(in Special Olympics)

Primary Basis: The athlete's skill level, ability, age, and gender.
Goal: Group athletes with similar performance abilities for a fair chance to win.
Process: Based on scores from preliminary events or trials.

INCLUSION AND ACCESSIBILITY IN SPORTS

What is Inclusion?

Creating an environment where people with and without disabilities have equal opportunities to participate in sports together.



Why is Inclusion Important?

It boosts confidence and motor skills for CWSN while teaching empathy, respect, and social skills to all participants.

Strategies to Make Activities Accessible



Medical Check-ups
Understand individual limitations and needs.



Modify Rules
Allow extra attempts, provide longer rest breaks.



Adapt Equipment
Use bright colors for visual impairment or lightweight objects for weaker muscles.



Create a Safe Environment
Ensure proper lighting, avoid loud noises, and have a suitable play area.

THE BENEFITS OF PHYSICAL ACTIVITY FOR CWSN

More Than Just a Game: Sports participation provides powerful holistic benefits for Children With Special Needs.



PHYSICAL BENEFITS

Improves muscle strength, coordination, balance, flexibility, and overall fitness.



SOCIAL BENEFITS

Enhances communication skills, teamwork, and social interaction, leading to new friendships.



PSYCHOLOGICAL & EMOTIONAL BENEFITS

Reduces stress and depression, boosts self-esteem, develops a positive attitude, and builds self-confidence.